

Boromir at the Council of Elrond

- an example of play

'Here is Boromir, a man from the South. He arrived in the grey morning, and seeks for counsel. I have bidden him to be present, for here his questions will be answered.'

Background

Boromir has travelled to Rivendell on a mission for his father. From the dream-rhyme, Denethor shrewdly guessed that Isildur's Bane could be a powerful weapon, and that the Sword that was broken must be Narsil. He therefore tasked his eldest son with bringing both to Minas Tirith to aid in the coming war, but cautioned him to conceal his true intentions from Elrond.

Set Resistance

Boromir's player tells the Loremaster that he wishes to achieve three objectives:

1. Find out what Isildur's Bane is;
2. Get the Council to agree that Isildur's Bane would come to Minas Tirith;
3. Get the Council to agree that the Sword that Was Broken would come to Minas Tirith.

The Loremaster decides this is a Bold request, but offers to make it a Reasonable request if the second objective is dropped. The player declines the offer, so 6 successes will be required.

Introduction

The player decides they will use **Awe** to introduce themselves to the Council. They roll a **Great Success**, so will have 5 attempts to achieve the 6 successes. Then the player narrates, doing their best to live up to their excellent roll:

Boromir stood up, tall and proud, before them. 'Give me leave, Master Elrond,' said he, 'first to say more of Gondor, for verily from the land of Gondor I am come. And it would be well for all to know what passes there. For few, I deem, know of our deeds, and therefore guess little at their peril, if we should fail at last.'

'Believe not that in the land of Gondor the blood of Númenor is spent, nor all its pride and dignity forgotten.'

'In this evil hour I have come on an errand over many dangerous leagues to Elrond: a hundred and ten days I have journeyed all alone. But I do not seek allies in war. The might of Elrond is in wisdom not in weapons, it is said. I come to ask for counsel and the unravelling of hard words.'

Interactions

The Loremaster decides that the audience has an Open attitude. A visitor of Boromir's status is welcome, but many years have passed since relations between Elves and the Men of Gondor were friendly. Boromir's attempts will not be modified.

Attempt 1 of 5

This time, the player decides to narrate first and roll afterwards. They explain their aim is to recount the dream-rhyme and part of the reason for Boromir's journey, without giving away Denethor's desire to secure Isildur's Bane for Minas Tirith. The Loremaster agrees that this is a suitable use of the **Riddle** skill.

'In that dream I thought the eastern sky grew dark and there was a growing thunder, but in the West a pale light lingered, and out of it I heard a voice, remote but clear, crying:

*Seek for the Sword that was broken:
In Imladris it dwells;
There shall be counsels taken
Stronger than Morgul-spells.
There shall be shown a token
That Doom is near at hand,
For Isildur's Bane shall waken,
And the Halfling forth shall stand.*

Of these words we could understand little, and we spoke to our father, Denethor, Lord of Minas Tirith, wise in the lore of Gondor. This only would he say, that Imladris was of old the name among the Elves of a far northern dale, where Elrond the Halfelven dwelt, greatest of lore-masters. Therefore my brother, seeing how desperate was our need, was eager to heed the dream and seek for Imladris; but since the way was full of doubt and danger, I took the journey upon myself. Loth was my father to give me leave, and long have I wandered by roads forgotten, seeking the house of Elrond, of which many had heard, but few knew where it lay.'

The player then rolls: a **success**.

Attempt 2 of 5

The player decides to roll **Insight** to see if they can glean any information about other members of the Council. This is difficult to role-play until the outcome is known, so they roll: a **failure**.

The Loremaster wants to reveal the purpose of the Council and sees the failed Insight roll as an opportunity to add a twist. First they describe "the lean face of the Ranger and his weather-stained cloak". Speaking as Elrond, they name him the heir of Isildur. Then, Frodo is called to bring forth the Ring.

The Loremaster tells the player that Boromir's attention is taken by the golden ring, so is caught off guard when the Ranger asks him if he wishes the House of Elendil to return to Gondor. He can't tell whether he is being deceived or played for a fool.

'I was not sent to beg any boon, but to seek only the meaning of a riddle,' answered Boromir proudly. 'Yet we are hard pressed, and the Sword of Elendil would be a help beyond our hope - if such a thing could indeed return out of the shadows of the past.' He looked again at Aragorn, and doubt was in his eyes.

Attempt 3 of 5

The Loremaster, speaking as Gandalf, now tells his story, including his research at Minas Tirith.

The player wants to draw on Boromir's own knowledge of Gondor's history to judge the truth of what he's been told and see if he can gain any leverage, so rolls **Lore**: a **success**.

'Some in the North, maybe,' Boromir broke in. 'All know in Gondor that he went first to Minas Anor and dwelt a while with his nephew Meneldil, instructing him, before he committed to him the rule of the South Kingdom. In that time he planted there the last sapling of the White Tree in memory of his brother.'

Attempt 4 of 5

Gandalf tells of the betrayal of Saruman and his flight to Rohan, including Gwaihir's tale of the Rohirrim paying a tribute of horses to Mordor.

Needing four successes from the remaining two rolls, Boromir's player turns to one of his strongest skills - **Enhearten**. He tries to counter Gandalf's gloomy tale and rolls a **great success**.

'Nor is it now, I will swear,' said Boromir. 'It is a lie that comes from the Enemy. I know the Men of Rohan, true and valiant, our allies, dwelling still in the lands that we gave them long ago.'

'The shadow of Mordor lies on distant lands,' answered Aragorn. 'Saruman has fallen under it, Rohan is beset. Who knows what you will find there, if ever you return?'

'Not this at least,' said Boromir, 'that they will buy their lives with horses. They love their horses next to their kin. And not without reason, for the horses of the Riddermark come from the fields of the North, far from the Shadow, and their race, as that of their masters, is descended from the free days of old.'

'True indeed!' said Gandalf.

Attempt 5 of 5

Needing a great success from his final attempt, Boromir's player decides to lay out his case for the Ring to come to Minas Tirith, in an attempt to **Persuade** the Council.

'I do not understand all this,' he said. 'Saruman is a traitor, but did he not have a glimpse of wisdom? Why do you speak ever of hiding or destroying? Why should we not think that the Great Ring has come into our hands to serve us in the very hour of need? Wielding it the Free Lords of the Free must surely defeat the Enemy. That is what he most fears, I deem.'

'The Men of Gondor are valiant, and they will never submit; but they may be beaten down. Valour needs first strength, and then a weapon. Let the Ring be your weapon, if it has such power as you say. Take it and go forth to victory!'

Before the roll, the Loremaster rules that Boromir's **resentful** flaw will apply, so the roll is ill-favoured. The player rolls a **failure**.

The Loremaster, speaking as Elrond, explains they cannot use the ring.

Boromir looked at them doubtfully, but he bowed his head. 'So be it,' he said. 'Then in Gondor we must trust to such weapons as we have. And at the least, while the Wise ones guard this Ring, we will fight on. Mayhap the Sword-that-was-Broken may still stem the tide - if the hand that wields it has inherited not an heirloom only, but the sinews of the Kings of Men.'

Outcome

The Council is a failure, but the successful introduction means it has not been a disaster.

It is decided that Boromir will be in the Company, but the Ring will go to Mount Doom to be destroyed, not to Minas Tirith as he desired.